FÁBIO BENTZ MACIEL

Department of Spatial Economics, School of Business and Economics
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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam 2024 – present

- Department of Spatial Economics; funded by the Swiss National Science Foundation (Grant No. 212632)
- Supervisors: Steven Poelhekke and Joëlle Noailly

M.Sc. in Economics, Universidade Federal Fluminense (UFF), Brazil 2020 – 2022

B.A. in Economics, Universidade Federal do Rio de Janeiro (UFRJ), Brazil 2015 – 2019

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Development Economics, Environmental and Resource Economics, Economics of Education, Labor Economics

WORK IN PROGRESS

"Mines, Farms and Forests: Evidence from Brazil" (with Ayse-Nihal Yilmaz, Joëlle Noailly, and Steven Poelhekke). *Lead author.*

"Made in Brazil: Job Creation and Firm Performance Under a Local Content Requirement" (with Erik Katovich). *Working paper coming soon.* Funded by a STEG Small Research Grant.

"Local Labor Market Effects of Higher Education Expansion: Evidence from Brazil" (with Milena Nakashima and Erik Katovich).

"Skills or Scars? The Legacy of Mining Booms on Firm and Worker Capabilities" (with Erik Katovich and Steven Poelhekke). *Lead author.*

PRE-PHD RESEARCH AND TECHNICAL REPORTS

"Impactos da educação profissional no mercado de trabalho brasileiro" (with Romero Rocha). *Pesquisa e Planejamento Econômico*, 54(3), 2024. [In Portuguese. English title: "The Impacts of Vocational Education on the Brazilian Labor Market."]

"Public Spending and Pupils' Achievement: Evidence from Public Elementary Schools in Brazil" (with Fábio Waltenberg and André Sant'Anna). CEDE Discussion Paper No. 179, 2025. *Lead author.*

"Um Fundeb mais progressivo: efeitos redistributivos da ponderação pelo nível socioeconômico e pela disponibilidade de recursos vinculados à educação" (with Adriano Senkevics, Maria Teresa Alves, and Victor Bridi). IPEA Discussion Paper No. 3201, 2026. [In Portuguese. English

title: "A More Progressive FUNDEB: Redistributive Effects of Weighting by Socioeconomic Status and by Earmarked Education Revenues."]

"Financiamento federal a estudantes: proposições para remodelagem do Fies, sua integração com renúncias e imunidades fiscais e extensão de seu alcance a cursos de EPT" (with Paulo Nascimento, Rafael Tavares, and Abigail Santos). IPEA Discussion Paper No. 3074, 2024. [In Portuguese. English title: "Federal Student Financing: Proposals to Redesign FIES, Integrate It with Tax Exemptions and Immunities, and Extend It to Vocational and Technological Education."]

"Domicílios unipessoais e pobreza no Brasil pós-pandemia" (with Pedro Souza). IPEA Technical Note No. 114, 2024. [In Portuguese. English title: "Single-Person Households and Poverty in Post-Pandemic Brazil."]

"Avaliação do gasto tributário do imposto de renda dos aposentados no Brasil" (with André Fritscher, Renata Café, Fernando Silveira, and Leonardo Alvim). Inter-American Development Bank, Technical Note No. IDB-TN-2671, 2023. [In Portuguese. English title: "Evaluating the Income-Tax Expenditure for Retirees in Brazil."]

"Desigualdade salarial no setor formal da economia brasileira: a importância dos componentes intrafirma, entre firmas e entre setores" (with Pedro Souza and Miguel Foguel). *Mercado de Trabalho: Conjuntura e Análise*, No. 76, IPEA, 2023. [In Portuguese. English title: "Wage Inequality in Brazil's Formal Sector: Within-Firm, Between-Firm, and Between-Sector Components."]

Co-author, social assistance chapter, in *Maravilhosa para Todos: Políticas Públicas para o Rio de Janeiro*, eds. Eduardo Bandeira de Mello, Andrea Gouvêa Vieira, and Ricardo Menezes Barboza, 2020. [In Portuguese. English title: "Wonderful for All: Public Policies for Rio de Janeiro."]

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant to Erik Katovich 2022 – 2023

Natural resources and local development in Brazil, using administrative data from the Ministry of Labor (RAIS) and the National Mining Agency (Cadastro Mineiro).

Researcher, Institute for Applied Economic Research (IPEA) 2022 – 2024

Research incentive grant. Labor-market inequality dynamics and higher-education financing, using administrative data from the Ministry of Labor (RAIS) and the National Education Development Fund (SIS-FIES).

Research Scholar, Fundação Euclides da Cunha (UFF) 2021 – 2022

Ex-ante and ex-post evaluation of cash-transfer programs in two municipalities of the state of Rio de Janeiro, under the project "Renda Básica de Cidadania."

Undergraduate Research Assistant (PIBIC/CNPq Fellowship), UFRJ 2016 – 2018

POLICY AND CONSULTING EXPERIENCE

External Consultant, World Bank 2025

Labor-market projections supporting Brazilian state governments' technical-education planning under the PROPAG program.

External Consultant, INEP (Brazilian Ministry of Education) 2024 – 2025

Built and consolidated the calculation routines for the indicators that determine the VAAR

component of FUNDEB, Brazil's main K–12 education fund.

Consultant, UNESCO, for the Brazilian Ministry of Education 2023 – 2024

Simulated the redistributive consequences of adding socioeconomic and earmarked-revenue criteria to the allocation of federal K–12 education funding.

External Product Consultant, Inter-American Development Bank 2021 – 2022

Tax-incidence analysis using the PNADC household survey and Federal Revenue Service data.

Short-Term Consultant, Profissão Docente 2021

Municipal-level assessment of teacher shortages in K–12 public education, matching teachers' qualifications to teaching assignments using INEP School Census microdata.

Intern, Brazilian Institute of Geography and Statistics (IBGE) 2019

Automated data-collection and analysis routines in R for the team producing the Brazilian Monthly Retail Survey (PMC).

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam

Environmental and Resource Economics (M.Sc. STREEM) 2025, 2026

Spatial Econometrics (M.Sc. STREEM) 2026

Economics of Climate Change (M.Sc. STREEM) 2025

Teaching Assistant, Universidade Federal Fluminense (UFF)

Econometrics (undergraduate) 2021

Teaching Assistant, Universidade Federal do Rio de Janeiro (UFRJ)

Monetary Economics (undergraduate) 2019

FELLOWSHIPS AND GRANTS

Swiss National Science Foundation, doctoral funding (Grant No. 212632) 2024 – present

STEG Small Research Grant, CEPR (for "Made in Brazil," with Erik Katovich)

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Graduate Student Representative, Postgraduate Council, UFF 2021 – 2022

SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Programming

R and Stata (advanced); QGIS (geospatial analysis); Python, SQL, and SAS (basic); LaTeX.

Languages

Portuguese (native); English (fluent); Spanish (intermediate).

Last updated: October 2026